

GROUP DYNAMICS



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Group Dynamics--Dr. Carolyn Stevenson

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1: Introduction to Group Dynamics and Social Justice

Group Dynamics

Course Description

This course explores the theory and practice of group dynamics through the lens of social justice. Students examine how power, identity, privilege, oppression, communication, leadership, conflict, and collective action shape group behavior in educational, organizational, and community settings. Emphasis is placed on experiential learning, critical reflection, collaboration, and equity-centered practices.

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

1. Explain major theories of group dynamics.
2. Analyze how social identities and systems of power influence group processes.
3. Apply equity and inclusion frameworks to group interaction.
4. Demonstrate effective communication and conflict resolution skills.
5. Critically evaluate leadership styles in diverse groups.
6. Facilitate collaborative and socially just group practices.
7. Design strategies for collective action and community engagement.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Foundations of Group Theory

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2.1: Foundations of Group Theory – Readings and Videos

The readings and videos introduce the history of group dynamics, highlighting how early research helped explain group behavior, communication, and the influence of groups on individuals. They also examine stages of group development, including how groups form, manage conflict, establish norms, and become effective through collaboration and shared goals.

Readings

Reading 1

This reading introduces the history of group dynamics and explains why studying groups is important. Students will learn about the early work of Kurt Lewin and how his research helped establish group dynamics as a field focused on understanding how people interact, communicate, and influence one another in groups.

American Psychological Association. (2007). *Kurt Lewin and the origins of group dynamics*. APA Monitor on Psychology. <https://www.apa.org/monitor/2007/10/lewin>

Reading 2

This reading explains how groups develop over time and introduces Tuckman's stages of group development. Students will learn how groups move through stages, experience challenges, build relationships, and become more effective through communication and collaboration.

Mind Tools Content Team. (n.d.). *Forming, storming, norming, and performing*. Mind Tools. <https://www.mindtools.com/a4wo118/fo...and-performing>

Videos

Video 1

This video explores how individuals who do not know each other can develop into effective teams through communication, collaboration, psychological safety, and shared learning. Students will examine how group members build trust, manage challenges, and create conditions that support effective group functioning.

Edmondson, A. C. (2017). *How to turn a group of strangers into a team* [Video]. TED. https://www.ted.com/talks/amy_edmondson_how_to_turn_a_group_of_strangers_into_a_team

Video 2

This video explains Tuckman's stages of group development and describes how groups move through stages as they develop. Students will examine how forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning influence communication, teamwork, conflict management, and group effectiveness.

Flixabout.com. (2025). *Tuckman stages of group development describes the typical stages of a group or team* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-OXQw2-PsAk>

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2.2: Foundations of Group Theory - Classroom Activity

Individual Classroom Activity: “Understanding How Groups Develop and Function”

Students will complete an individual reflection activity exploring the history, theories, and stages of group dynamics. Through guided questions, students will identify key contributors, compare group development models, and apply concepts to a personal group experience.

Learning Outcomes

By completing this activity, students will be able to:

- Summarize the historical development of group dynamics and explain its importance in understanding group processes.
- Identify major theorists and compare key models that explain group behavior and development.
- Analyze stages of group development and evaluate their impact on group effectiveness.

Part 1: History of Group Dynamics (10 minutes)

Directions: Review course materials/readings on the history of group dynamics and respond to the questions below.

1. Why is understanding group dynamics important when studying how groups function?
2. Identify one contribution made by Kurt Lewin to the study of groups.

Part 2: Theorists and Models Comparison (15 minutes)

Directions: Complete the chart by comparing major group dynamics theories/models.

Theorist/Model	Main Idea	How It Explains Group Behavior
Kurt Lewin		
Bruce Tuckman		
Other group theory/model		

Reflection Questions:

1. Which model best explains how groups develop over time? Why?
2. How are the models similar? How are they different?

Part 3: Applying the Stages of Group Development (15 minutes)

Directions: Think of a group you have participated in (class project, workplace team, family group, club, or community organization).

Identify examples of the group moving through the stages of development:

Forming:

How did members get introduced and establish expectations?

Storming:

What disagreements, challenges, or conflicts occurred?

Norming:

How did the group develop shared expectations or improve communication?

Performing:

How did the group work together to accomplish its goals?

Final Reflection (5 minutes)

Answer the following:

What is one thing you learned about how groups develop and what makes them effective?

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2.3: Foundations of Group Theory – Assignment

Assignment: Analyzing Group Dynamics: History, Theories, and Development

Assignment Overview

Students will explore the development of group dynamics as a field of study, examine major theories and models, and apply group development concepts to a real-life group experience. This assignment will help students understand how groups form, function, manage challenges, and become effective.

Learning Outcomes

By completing this assignment, students will be able to:

1. Summarize the historical development of group dynamics and explain its significance in understanding group processes.
2. Identify major theorists and compare key models that have contributed to the study of group dynamics.
3. Analyze stages of group development and evaluate how each stage influences group functioning and effectiveness.

Assignment Instructions

Part 1: History of Group Dynamics (1–2 paragraphs)

Using course readings and resources, explain the historical development of group dynamics.

Address the following:

- What is group dynamics?
- Why is the study of groups important?
- How did early researchers contribute to understanding group behavior?
- What role did Kurt Lewin play in the development of group dynamics?

Part 2: Compare Group Dynamics Theories/Models (Table or Written Response)

Choose two group dynamics theorists or models and compare their contributions.

Examples may include:

- Kurt Lewin — field theory and group processes
- Bruce Tuckman — stages of group development

Include:

- Main ideas of each theory/model
- Similarities and differences
- How each model helps explain group behavior

Submission Requirements

- Length: 2-3 pages (excluding references)
- MLA format

- Include at least two scholarly sources
- Use headings for each section
- Include a reference page

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

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3.1: Group Formation and Development – Readings and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos introduce the foundations of group formation and development by examining how groups emerge, establish roles and norms, manage conflict, and progress through stages of development. Together, these resources highlight the importance of communication, trust, leadership, collaboration, and group processes in creating effective and productive teams.

Reading 1

This reading introduces the foundations of group formation and explains how individuals come together to create groups with shared goals, roles, norms, and expectations. Students will explore how communication, leadership, and group structure influence how groups develop and function.

Forsyth, D. R. (2021). *Group dynamics* (8th ed.). Cengage Learning. <https://www.cengage.com/c/group-dynamics-8e-forsyth/>

Reading 2

This reading examines how communication influences the formation and development of small groups. Students will explore how group members create roles, establish norms, manage conflict, and make decisions while working toward shared goals.

Branney, P. (n.d.). *Small group communication*. Open Textbook Library. <https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks/textbooks/small-group-communication>

Videos

Video 1

This video introduces the concept of group dynamics, explains how groups form, and explores Tuckman's stages of group development. Students will learn how groups move through stages of development and how communication, roles, and relationships influence group effectiveness.

Bhandwalkar, V. (2022). *Group dynamics I group formation 5 stages in organisational behaviour I stages of group development* [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3hiL_HTIvvc

Video 2

This video lecture examines the stages groups experience as they develop and highlights how group processes influence interaction, collaboration, and outcomes. Students will explore how understanding group stages can help members improve communication and contribute to more effective teamwork.

Field, T. (2018). *Group dynamics and process: Group stages* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=heiHPh-b4fc>

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3.2: Group Formation and Development - Classroom Activity

Instructions: This discussion activity allows students to apply group dynamics concepts to real-world experiences by examining how groups form, develop, and become effective. Share your reflections with classmates.

Think about a group you have been part of (class, workplace, community, or social group). What factors influenced how the group was formed, organized, and structured?

How did the group move through different stages of development (forming, storming, norming, performing)? What challenges or successes occurred during these stages?

What factors had the greatest impact on the group's effectiveness? What strategies could improve the group's functioning?

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3.3: Group Formation and Development – Assignment

Individual Assignment: Analyzing Group Formation and Development

Assignment Overview

Students will analyze the formation and development of real-world group experience by applying concepts and theories of group dynamics. Through reflection and analysis, students will examine how groups are created, how they progress through developmental stages, and how communication, leadership, roles, trust, and conflict management influence group effectiveness.

Learning Outcomes

By completing this assignment, students will be able to:

1. Explain the process of group formation by identifying factors that influence how groups are created, structured, and organized.
2. Analyze stages of group development by examining how groups progress through formation, conflict, collaboration, and goal achievement.
3. Evaluate factors that influence group effectiveness, including communication, leadership, roles, norms, trust, and conflict management.
4. Apply group development theories and concepts to assess real-world group experiences and identify strategies for improving group functioning and outcomes.

Part 1: Describe the Group Formation Process (1–2 pages)

Select a group you have participated in or observed. Examples include:

- Classroom/project team
- Workplace team
- Student organization
- Community group
- Sports team
- Volunteer group

Describe the group by answering the following questions:

1. What was the purpose or goal of the group?
2. How was the group formed?
3. Who were the members, and what roles did they have?
4. What factors influenced how the group was structured and organized?
 - Shared goals
 - Member skills or backgrounds
 - Leadership
 - Communication methods
 - Expectations or rules

Part 2: Evaluate Group Effectiveness (1–2 pages)

Evaluate the factors that influenced the success or challenges of the group.

Discuss:

Communication

- How did members share information and make decisions?
- Was communication effective? Why or why not?

Leadership

- What leadership approaches were used?
- How did leadership influence the group?

Roles and Norms

- What roles did members take on?
- What expectations or rules guided group behavior?

Trust and Conflict Management

- How did members build trust?
- How were disagreements handled?

Submission Requirements

- Length: 2-4 pages (excluding references)
- MLA format
- Include at least two references from course readings or scholarly sources
- Use headings and citations where appropriate

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: Group Roles and Responsibilities

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4.1: Group Roles and Responsibilities - Reading and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos provide an overview of how group roles, responsibilities, and accountability influence team effectiveness, communication, and performance. Together, they emphasize the importance of role clarity, collaboration, delegation, and managing expectations to strengthen group cohesion, reduce conflict, and support successful team outcomes.

Reading 1

This reading examines how groups develop structures, establish roles, and influence individual behavior within collective settings. This reading supports students in identifying formal and informal group roles, understanding role expectations, and evaluating how communication, cohesion, leadership, and conflict affect group effectiveness and performance. It directly aligns with learning outcomes focused on role identification, role clarity, and the impact of group dynamics on team success.

Forsyth, D. R. (2021). *Group dynamics* (7th ed.). Cengage Learning.

<https://www.cengage.com/c/group-dynamics-7e-forsyth/>

Reading 2

This reading provides a practical framework for understanding effective teamwork through shared accountability, complementary skills, commitment, and collective responsibility. This reading supports students' ability to analyze individual contributions within teams, apply strategies for effective role assignment and delegation, and evaluate how role clarity and accountability contribute to group productivity and long-term success.

Katzenbach, J. R., & Smith, D. K. (1993). *The wisdom of teams: Creating the high-performance organization*. Harvard Business Review Press.

<https://store.hbr.org/product/the-wisdom-of-teams-creating-the-high-performance-organization/1007>

Videos

Video 1

This video introduces the importance of defining team roles, assigning responsibilities, and understanding how individual contributions influence group effectiveness. It supports students' ability to identify formal and informal roles within teams, recognize the value of role clarity, and evaluate how responsibilities influence communication, collaboration, and team performance. These concepts connect with Forsyth's (2021) discussion of group structure, member roles, and group functioning.

Word Wisdom. (2023, August 28). *Mastering teamwork: Roles & responsibilities in a team* [Video]. YouTube.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TrwoQsjMM0w>

Video 2

This video examines how individual roles, expectations, and perceptions affect group interactions. It highlights how unclear responsibilities or conflicting expectations can contribute to group conflict and

reduced effectiveness. This resource supports students in evaluating role clarity, role conflict, and strategies for improving cohesion and collaboration within teams. The content aligns with Forsyth's (2021) emphasis on group processes and Katzenbach and Smith's (1993) focus on accountability and collective responsibility.

Study.com. (n.d.). *Roles of group members: Perceptions, expectations & conflict* [Video]. Study.com.
<https://study.com/academy/lesson/video/roles-of-group-members-perceptions-expectations-conflict.html>

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4.2: Group Roles and Responsibilities - Classroom Activity

In-Class Activity: Building an Effective Team: Group Roles and Responsibilities

Student Learning Outcomes

By the end of this activity, students will be able to:

1. Identify and analyze different group roles by distinguishing between formal and informal roles and explaining how they influence communication, collaboration, and team effectiveness.
2. Evaluate individual responsibilities within a team by examining the relationship between accountability, participation, and collaboration in achieving group goals.
3. Develop strategies for effective role assignment and delegation to improve team organization, decision-making, conflict management, and overall group performance.

Purpose

This activity provides students with an opportunity to apply group dynamics concepts by examining how roles, responsibilities, and expectations influence team success. Through discussion, analysis, and problem-solving, students will explore how effective role management can improve communication, accountability, and group cohesion.

Activity Overview

Students will work in groups of 4–6 members to analyze a team-based scenario and develop recommendations for creating an effective and productive group. Teams may select a context such as a workplace project, athletic team, student organization, community initiative, or organizational task force.

Part 1: Identifying Group Roles (15 minutes)

Each group will identify the formal and informal roles needed within their selected team setting.

Discuss and record:

- What formal roles exist within the group (e.g., team leader, project coordinator, facilitator, recorder, decision-maker)?
- What informal roles may develop (e.g., motivator, communicator, problem-solver, supporter, challenger)?
- How do these roles influence communication, decision-making, and team performance?

Discussion Questions:

1. Which roles are essential for achieving group goals?
2. How can informal roles positively or negatively affect team effectiveness?
3. What challenges may occur when roles are unclear or overlap?

Part 2: Evaluating Responsibilities and Accountability (15 minutes)

Groups will create a team task or project scenario and assign responsibilities to each member.

Identify:

- Individual responsibilities required for successful completion of the task

- Expectations for participation and contribution
- Methods for maintaining accountability
- Strategies for encouraging collaboration and shared responsibility

Discussion Questions:

1. How does individual accountability affect overall team success?
2. What impact does unequal participation have on group morale and performance?
3. How can teams encourage members to take ownership of their responsibilities?

Assignment Deliverable

Each group will submit a one-page summary or deliver a brief 5-minute presentation addressing:

1. The formal and informal roles identified within the team
2. How responsibilities and accountability influence team outcomes
3. Strategies for assigning roles and delegating tasks effectively
4. Recommendations for improving role clarity, managing conflict, and strengthening team success

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4.3: Group Roles and Responsibilities - Assignment

Group Roles and Responsibilities – Assignment

Case Analysis Assignment: Managing Group Roles and Responsibilities for Team Success

By completing this case analysis, students will be able to:

1. Analyze group roles and responsibilities by identifying how formal and informal roles influence communication, collaboration, decision-making, and team effectiveness.
2. Evaluate team dynamics and performance challenges by examining the impact of accountability, participation, role expectations, and conflict on achieving group goals.
3. Develop evidence-based strategies for improving team effectiveness by recommending approaches for role clarification, delegation, conflict management, and strengthening group cohesion.

Case Analysis: The Struggling Project Team

Case Scenario

A university department has created a five-member team to develop a campus-wide student engagement initiative. The team includes members with different skills and backgrounds, but the project has experienced several challenges during implementation.

The team leader, Jordan, was selected because of previous leadership experience but has not clearly communicated expectations or assigned specific responsibilities. Two team members, Alex and Morgan, frequently take control of discussions and make decisions without consulting the rest of the group. Taylor, who has strong research skills, rarely participates because they feel their ideas are not valued. Casey often misses deadlines because they are unclear about which tasks they are responsible for completing.

As the project deadline approaches, frustration among team members increases. Some members believe the workload is unfairly distributed, while others feel that communication within the group is ineffective. The team begins experiencing conflict, reduced motivation, and difficulty making decisions. Although each member has valuable skills, the group is struggling to work together effectively.

Case Analysis Questions

Part 1: Identifying Group Roles and Responsibilities

1. Identify the formal and informal roles present within the team.

Who appears to be taking leadership roles?

Are there members assuming informal roles such as supporter, challenger, communicator, or problem-solver?

2. How have unclear roles and responsibilities affected team communication and performance?
3. What roles or responsibilities should be clarified to improve the team's effectiveness?

Part 2: Reflection and Application

Based on this case, explain why role clarity is important for long-term team success. Provide at least two recommendations for preventing similar challenges in future teams.

Submission Requirements

Format: Written case analysis

Length: 2-3 pages (excluding title page and references)

Formatting: MLA style

Your analysis should include:

- Introduction summarizing the team challenge
- Responses to the case analysis questions
- Application of group dynamics concepts from course readings
- Recommendations for improving team effectiveness
- Conclusion summarizing key lessons about roles and responsibilities

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

5: Group Norms and Expectations

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5.1: Group Norms and Expectations- Readings and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos explore how group norms and expectations develop and influence member behavior, communication, accountability, and overall team effectiveness. Together, they provide strategies for creating productive team standards that strengthen collaboration, trust, cohesion, and long-term group success.

Reading 1

Forsyth examines how group norms emerge as shared expectations that guide member behavior, communication, and decision-making. The text explains how norms influence conformity, participation, cohesion, and performance while highlighting the importance of understanding both productive and dysfunctional group behaviors. This reading supports students' ability to analyze how group expectations shape interactions and evaluate strategies for developing effective team norms.

Forsyth, D. R. (2021). *Group dynamics* (7th ed.). Cengage Learning.

<https://www.cengage.com/c/group-dynamics-7e-forsyth/>

Reading 2

Hackman explores the conditions necessary for creating and maintaining effective teams, emphasizing the importance of clear expectations, supportive structures, and shared accountability. The book highlights how successful teams establish productive norms related to communication, collaboration, decision-making, and performance standards. This reading helps students understand how leaders and team members can intentionally create norms that improve trust, commitment, and group outcomes.

Hackman, J. R. (2002). *Leading teams: Setting the stage for great performances*. Harvard Business School Press.

<https://store.hbr.org/product/leading-teams-for-great-performances/1952>

Videos

Video 1

This video explains the importance of establishing team norms and shared expectations to guide group behavior and improve collaboration. It demonstrates how teams can create agreements around communication, decision-making, accountability, and conflict management to build trust and improve performance.

MindToolsVideos. (2018). *Team norms: Creating effective team agreements* [Video]. YouTube.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9gX9Q2fJZ0Q>

Video 2

This video examines how group norms develop over time and how they shape member behaviors, participation, and team relationships. It highlights the role of leaders and team members in creating positive expectations that support accountability, inclusion, and group cohesion.

Communication Coach Alex Lyon. (2020). *Group norms and team development* [Video]. YouTube.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5dLQ2j6vR7M>

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5.2: Group Norms and Expectations - Classroom Activity

Creating a High-Performing Team Charter

Purpose

This activity allows students to apply group dynamics concepts by examining how norms and expectations shape team behavior. Students will collaborate to create a virtual team charter that establishes guidelines for communication, accountability, decision-making, and conflict management.

Part 1: Virtual Team Norm Development (20–25 minutes)

Students will be assigned to small online groups. Each group will develop a Team Norms Charter for a hypothetical project team.

The team charter should include:

Communication Norms

- Preferred communication methods
- Expected response times
- Guidelines for respectful discussion and feedback

Participation Expectations

- Member responsibilities
- Expectations for preparation and engagement
- Strategies for ensuring all members contribute

Accountability Standards

- How deadlines will be managed
- How progress will be monitored
- How members will address missed responsibilities

Decision-Making Guidelines

- How decisions will be made
- How disagreements will be handled
- How diverse perspectives will be considered

Conflict Management Expectations

- Strategies for addressing disagreements
- Procedures for resolving misunderstandings
- Ways to maintain trust and respect

Part 2: Group Discussion and Analysis (15 minutes)

Each group will share its Team Norms Charter with the class.

Students will discuss:

1. Which norms are most important for creating an effective team?

2. How might unclear expectations negatively impact group performance?
3. Which norms may be difficult to maintain, and why?
4. How can leaders reinforce positive group behaviors?

Part 3: Individual Application Reflection (10 minutes)

Students will submit a brief reflection responding to:

“How do group norms influence team success, and what strategies can leaders and members use to create expectations that support collaboration, accountability, and cohesion?”

Assignment Submission Requirements

Students will submit:

- Group Team Norms Charter
- Final individual application reflection

Suggested Length:

- Individual reflection: 100–150 words
- Team Norms Charter: 1–2 pages

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5.3: Group Norms and Expectations - Assignment

Assignment: Group Norms, Social Justice, and Inclusive Team Effectiveness

Collaborative Group Project

Group Size: 4–5 students

Length: 6–8 pages plus presentation

Value: (Instructor determines)

Assignment Overview

Effective groups develop norms that influence communication, participation, accountability, decision-making, and overall effectiveness. In this project, your group will examine how group norms either promote or hinder equity, inclusion, and social justice within teams. Drawing upon course concepts and research, your group will analyze a real or hypothetical group and develop an inclusive set of group norms that foster psychological safety, collaboration, and equitable participation.

Assignment Instructions

Part 1: Understanding Group Norms (20%)

Explain:

- What are group norms?
- Why do groups develop norms?
- What is the difference between formal and informal norms?
- How do norms influence communication, trust, and collaboration?
- How do inclusive norms contribute to equitable participation?

Support your discussion with course readings and at least three scholarly sources.

Part 2: Group Analysis Through a Social Justice Lens (35%)

Select one of the following:

- a student project team
- workplace team
- nonprofit organization
- sports team
- community organization
- fictional group from film or television
- historical or contemporary social movement

Analyze:

- existing norms
- spoken and unspoken expectations
- who holds influence
- whose voices are centered
- whose voices may be excluded

- barriers to participation
- effects on communication
- decision-making
- accountability
- conflict
- overall effectiveness

Include discussion of:

- equity
- inclusion
- privilege
- bias
- power
- belonging
- accessibility

Part 3: Develop an Inclusive Group Norms Charter (30%)

Create a group norms document containing approximately 8–10 norms.

Examples include:

- Respect differing perspectives.
- Share airtime during discussions.
- Address conflict respectfully.
- Rotate leadership roles.
- Use inclusive language.
- Honor deadlines.
- Practice active listening.
- Seek consensus while valuing dissent.
- Provide constructive feedback.
- Ensure accessibility in meetings.

For each norm explain:

- Why it matters
- Which group challenge it addresses
- How it promotes equity and inclusion
- How accountability will be maintained

Part 4: Reflection (15%)

As a group, reflect on:

- Which norm was most important?
- Which norm would be hardest to maintain?
- What social justice issues emerged during your discussion?

- How can groups intentionally create inclusive environments?
- What did your group learn about working together?

Social Justice Emphasis

Throughout the assignment consider:

- Equity versus equality
- Inclusive leadership
- Accessibility
- Psychological safety
- Bias
- Power and privilege
- Cultural humility
- Respect for diverse identities
- Shared decision-making
- Accountability

Deliverables

- Group paper (6–8 pages)
- Group Norms Charter (1 page)
- 10–12 minute class presentation
- Reference page MLA format

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

6: Social Identity and Intersectionality

[6.1: Social Identity and Intersectionality – Readings and Videos](#)

[6.2: Social Identity and Intersectionality - Classroom Activity](#)

[6.3: Social Identity and Intersectionality - Assignment](#)

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6.1: Social Identity and Intersectionality – Readings and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos explain how social identities develop through group memberships and how these identities influence individual experiences, relationships, and interactions within groups. Together, they highlight how intersecting identities shape experiences of privilege, marginalization, and inclusion, emphasizing the importance of understanding diversity and social context in group dynamics.

Reading 1

This reading introduces the concept of intersectionality, explaining how overlapping social identities influence experiences of privilege, discrimination, and marginalization. This reading emphasizes that identities such as race, gender, class, and other social categories cannot always be understood separately because their intersections create unique experiences within social and organizational contexts.

Crenshaw, K. (1989). Demarginalizing the intersection of race and sex: A Black feminist critique of antidiscrimination doctrine, feminist theory and antiracist politics. *University of Chicago Legal Forum*, 1989(1), Article 8, 139–167. <https://chicagounbound.uchicago.edu/uclf/vol1989/iss1/8/>

Reading 2

Tajfel and Turner's foundational work on social identity theory explains how individuals define themselves through membership in social groups and how group identification influences perceptions, attitudes, and interactions with others. The reading explores processes such as in-group and out-group formation, social categorization, and group comparison, helping students understand how identities shape individual experiences and group dynamics.

Tajfel, H., & Turner, J. C. (1986). The social identity theory of intergroup behavior. In S. Worchel & W. G. Austin (Eds.), *Psychology of intergroup relations* (2nd ed., pp. 7–24). Nelson-Hall. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/230511111_Social_Identity_Theory_of_Intergroup_Behavior

Videos

Video 1

This video introduces the concept of social identity and explains how individuals develop a sense of self through membership in social groups. It examines in-group and out-group dynamics, social categorization, and how group identities influence perceptions, attitudes, and interactions with others.

CrashCourse. (2018, November 12). *Social identity theory: Crash Course Psychology #37* [Video]. YouTube.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3Y2gQeM6gI>

Video 2

This video explains the concept of intersectionality and how multiple aspects of identity can combine to shape individuals' experiences with opportunity, discrimination, and social systems. It encourages viewers to recognize the complexity of identity and consider how overlapping identities influence experiences of privilege and marginalization.

TEDx Talks. (2016, October 4). *The urgency of intersectionality* [Video]. YouTube.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=akOe5-UsQ2o>

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6.2: Social Identity and Intersectionality - Classroom Activity

Individual Classroom Activity (5 Minutes): Identity Mapping and Group Experiences

Activity Purpose

This brief reflection activity helps students examine how social identities influence individual experiences, group interactions, and perceptions of inclusion, privilege, and belonging.

Activity Instructions (5 Minutes)

Step 1: Individual Identity Reflection (3 minutes)

Students will privately reflect on the following questions:

1. What social identities (e.g., culture, profession, age, gender, nationality, education, interests, or other meaningful identities) influence how you see yourself within groups?
2. Which identities are most visible to others, and which may be less visible?
3. How might your identities influence your experiences, communication style, or participation in group settings?

Step 2: Group Dynamics Connection (2 minutes)

Students will respond to the following prompt:

“How can awareness of different social identities help groups create stronger communication, collaboration, and inclusion?”

Students may share general insights with the class without disclosing personal information they prefer to keep private.

Reflection Outcome

Students should recognize that group members bring diverse identities and experiences that influence perspectives, behaviors, and interactions. Understanding social identity and intersectionality can help groups reduce assumptions, improve inclusion, and strengthen collaboration.

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6.3: Social Identity and Intersectionality - Assignment

Video Assignment: Social Identity and Intersectionality Reflection

Assignment Purpose

This assignment allows students to apply concepts of social identity and intersectionality by creating a brief video reflection that examines how identities influence individual experiences, group interactions, and social relationships. Students will connect course concepts to real-world examples while considering the role of identity, privilege, and inclusion within groups.

Student Learning Outcomes

By completing this assignment, students will be able to:

1. Explain how social identities are formed and describe how identity influences individual perspectives, behaviors, and group experiences.
2. Analyze the impact of intersectionality by examining how multiple identities interact to shape experiences within diverse groups and social contexts.
3. Evaluate the influence of identity, privilege, and marginalization on group interactions and recommend strategies for creating more inclusive environments.

Assignment Instructions

Create a 3-Minute Video Reflection

Students will record a 3-minute video addressing the following prompts:

Part 1: Understanding Social Identity (Approximately 1 minute)

Explain:

- What is social identity, and how does it influence how individuals see themselves and others?
- Identify examples of social identities that may influence group experiences (e.g., culture, profession, age, education, gender, socioeconomic background, interests, or other meaningful identities).

Part 2: Exploring Intersectionality (Approximately 1 minute)

Discuss:

- What is intersectionality, and why is it important when understanding diverse group experiences?
- Provide an example of how multiple identities can influence a person's experiences, opportunities, or interactions within a group.

Part 3: Application to Group Dynamics (Approximately 1 minute)

Reflect on:

- How can awareness of social identity and intersectionality improve communication and collaboration within groups?
- What strategies can leaders or team members use to create more inclusive group environments?

Video Requirements

- Length: Approximately 3 minutes
- Format: Video recording (presentation, discussion, or narrated slides)
- Students should reference at least one course reading or video resource
- Professional and respectful communication is expected
- Personal disclosure is optional; students may use examples from workplace, academic, community, or hypothetical settings

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

7: Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups

[7.1: Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups – Readings and Videos](#)

[7.2: Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups - Classroom Activity](#)

[7.3: Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups - Assignment](#)

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7.1: Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups – Readings and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos examine how power operates within groups through formal and informal forms of influence and how privilege shapes individuals' experiences, relationships, and opportunities. Together, they encourage critical reflection on power dynamics, oppression, and strategies for creating more equitable, inclusive, and socially responsible group environments.

Reading 1

French and Raven's foundational work explores different forms of social power, including legitimate, reward, coercive, expert, referent, and informational power. This reading helps students understand how power operates within groups and how different sources of influence affect communication, decision-making, leadership, and relationships among group members.

French, J. R. P., Jr., & Raven, B. (1959). The bases of social power. In D. Cartwright (Ed.), *Studies in social power* (pp. 150–167). Institute for Social Research, University of Michigan.

https://www.researchgate.net/publication/301111111_Social_Power

Reading 2

This reading examines the concept of privilege by describing how unearned advantages can shape individuals' experiences, opportunities, and interactions within social systems. This reading encourages students to reflect on how privilege operates in everyday contexts and how awareness of privilege can contribute to more equitable and inclusive group relationships.

McIntosh, P. (1989). White privilege: Unpacking the invisible knapsack. *Peace and Freedom*, 49(4), 10–12.

https://www.wellesley.edu/sites/default/files/2019-01/white_privilege.pdf

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7.2: Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups - Classroom Activity

Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups Classroom Activity

Exploring Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups

Student Learning Outcomes

By participating in this discussion, students will be able to:

1. Differentiate between structural and interpersonal forms of power and analyze how power influences communication, decision-making, and relationships within groups.
2. Examine the impact of privilege and oppression by reflecting on how social identities and unequal access to resources influence group experiences and interactions.
3. Evaluate strategies for promoting equity and inclusion by identifying ways groups can address power imbalances and support meaningful participation among members.

Discussion Instructions

Time: 15–20 minutes

Format: Small-group discussion followed by class sharing

1. Review the assigned readings on power, privilege, and oppression in groups.
2. Discuss the questions provided below with your group.
3. Identify key themes, examples, and strategies related to effective group dynamics.
4. Select one main insight from your discussion to share with the class.
5. Focus on analyzing concepts and systems rather than making assumptions about individuals' personal experiences.

Discussion Question 1: Understanding Power Dynamics

Question:

How do different forms of power (e.g., positional authority, expertise, relationships, access to resources, or social influence) affect communication and decision-making within groups?

Guiding Prompts:

- Who typically holds influence in group settings, and why?
- How can power be used positively to support group goals?
- How might unequal power distribution create barriers to participation or collaboration?

Discussion Question 2: Privilege, Oppression, and Creating Inclusive Groups

Question:

How can awareness of privilege and oppression help groups create more equitable and inclusive environments?

Guiding Prompts:

- How might individuals' social identities influence their experiences within groups?
- How can privilege affect whose ideas are heard, valued, or acted upon?

- What actions can group members and leaders take to reduce barriers and promote inclusion?

Discussion Reflection (Individual Exit Response)

Before leaving class, students will submit a brief response:

“What is one strategy groups can use to recognize power differences and create a more inclusive environment?”

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7.3: Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Groups - Assignment

Individual Assignment: Analyzing Power, Privilege, and Oppression in Group Dynamics

Assignment Purpose

This assignment provides students with an opportunity to apply concepts of power, privilege, and oppression to real-world group settings. Students will examine how power structures influence group interactions, how privilege shapes experiences and opportunities, and how individuals and groups can promote equity and inclusion.

Student Learning Outcomes

By completing this assignment, students will be able to:

1. Analyze different forms of power by explaining how structural and interpersonal power influence communication, decision-making, and relationships within groups.
2. Evaluate the influence of privilege and oppression by examining how social identities and unequal access to resources shape group experiences and interactions.
3. Develop strategies for promoting equity and inclusion by identifying approaches that reduce barriers, increase participation, and support positive group dynamics.

Assignment Options

Students may complete one of the following options:

Option 1: Written Analysis (2–3 Pages)

Topic: *Power, Privilege, and Oppression in a Group Setting*

Select a group context (e.g., workplace team, classroom group, athletic team, organization, community group, or online community) and analyze the role of power and privilege within that setting.

Your paper should address the following:

Introduction

- Describe the group or context being analyzed.
- Explain why understanding power, privilege, and oppression is important for effective group functioning.

Section 1: Power Dynamics

Discuss:

- What forms of power exist within this group (e.g., authority, expertise, social influence, access to resources)?
- How does power affect communication, decision-making, and participation?
- Are there examples of unequal power distribution?

Section 2: Privilege and Oppression

Discuss:

- How might privilege influence members' experiences within the group?
- Are certain voices, perspectives, or experiences more valued than others?
- How might oppression or exclusion affect group cohesion and effectiveness?

Section 3: Strategies for Equity and Inclusion

Provide recommendations for:

- Reducing power imbalances
- Increasing participation and representation
- Creating a more inclusive and supportive group environment

Conclusion

Summarize key insights about how power and privilege influence group dynamics.

Option 2: Video Reflection (2–3 Minutes)

Create a video presentation addressing the following questions:

1. How do power dynamics influence behavior and relationships within groups?
2. How can privilege shape individuals' experiences and opportunities within group settings?
3. What strategies can leaders and group members use to promote equity, inclusion, and positive social change?

Students may use examples from:

- Workplace experiences
- Academic teams
- Sports teams
- Community organizations
- Current events
- Hypothetical scenarios

Personal disclosure is optional.

Assignment Requirements

Written Submission

- Length: 2–3 pages
- MLA formatting
- Include at least two course sources
- Organized with headings and clear analysis

Video Submission

- Length: 2–3 minutes
- Professional presentation style
- Reference at least one course reading or resource
- Submit video file or link according to course instructions

Suggested Assignment Topics

Students may choose one of the following:

1. Power and Leadership in Team Decision-Making
2. How Privilege Influences Participation in Group Settings
3. The Impact of Social Identity on Experiences of Inclusion and Exclusion
4. Power Differences in Workplace Teams
5. Creating Equitable Group Norms and Practices
6. The Role of Bystanders in Addressing Oppression Within Groups
7. Barriers to Voice and Participation in Diverse Teams
8. Strategies for Building Inclusive and High-Performing Groups

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

8: Communication in Diverse Groups

[8.1: Communication in Diverse Groups – Readings and Videos](#)

[8.2: Communication in Diverse Groups - Classroom Activity](#)

[8.3: Communication in Diverse Groups - Assignment](#)

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8.1: Communication in Diverse Groups – Readings and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos emphasize that effective communication in diverse groups requires both awareness of verbal and nonverbal communication cues and the ability to actively listen to different perspectives. Together, they demonstrate how inclusive communication practices, empathy, and respectful engagement foster collaboration, trust, and equitable participation within group settings.

Reading 1

This article examines how nonverbal communication behaviors—such as eye contact, nodding, and facial expressions—influence engagement and effectiveness in collaborative groups. It supports learners in identifying differences between verbal and nonverbal communication and analyzing their impact on group interactions.

Paneth, L., Jeitziner, L. T., Rack, O., Opwis, K., & Zahn, C. (2024). *Zooming in: The role of nonverbal behavior in sensing the quality of collaborative group engagement*. *International Journal of Computer-Supported Collaborative Learning*, 19(2), 187–229. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11412-024-09422-7>

Reading 2

This reading provides practical strategies for respectful, equitable, and accessible communication across diverse identities, backgrounds, and experiences. It supports active listening, inclusive communication practices, and fostering belonging within groups.

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2024, August 5). *Creating inclusive communication*. <https://www.cdc.gov/niosh/healthcare/communication-resources/inclusive-communication.html>

Videos

Video 1

This TEDx talk emphasizes active listening as a tool for understanding different perspectives, reducing conflict, and building meaningful relationships. It directly supports the learning outcome of demonstrating active listening skills across differences in perspectives, identities, and experiences.

Ury, W. (2015, January 7). *The power of listening* [Video]. TEDx Talks. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=saxfavo1OQo>

Videos 2

This presentation explores effective communication practices, including listening, empathy, respect, and awareness of verbal and nonverbal cues. The video supports inclusive communication practices that foster respectful, equitable, and effective group engagement.

Headlee, C. (2015, May 7). *How to have a good conversation* [Video]. TEDx Talks. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H6n3iNh4XLI>

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8.2: Communication in Diverse Groups - Classroom Activity

In-Class Activity: Communication in Diverse Groups

Listen, Observe, Include

Purpose:

This activity helps learners recognize verbal and nonverbal communication cues, practice active listening, and apply inclusive communication strategies in a group setting.

Upon completion of this activity, learners will be able to:

1. Recognize verbal and nonverbal communication cues that influence understanding and engagement during group interactions.
2. Demonstrate active listening skills by accurately summarizing another person's perspective without interruption or judgment.
3. Reflect on how individual experiences and identities shape communication styles and perceptions within diverse groups.
4. Apply inclusive communication practices that promote respect, empathy, and equitable participation in collaborative settings.

Instructions (5 minutes total):

Step 1: Pair Share (2 minutes)

- Students pair up.
- Partner A has 1 minute to answer the prompt:

"Describe a time when you felt included or excluded in a group."

- Partner B listens without interrupting and pays attention to both verbal and nonverbal cues.

Step 2: Reflection and Feedback (2 minutes)

- Partner B summarizes what they heard in 30 seconds, focusing on the speaker's key message and emotions.
- Partner A provides feedback on whether they felt heard and understood.
- Switch roles and repeat.

Step 3: Whole-Class Debrief (1 minute)

Ask students:

- What nonverbal cues helped you understand your partner?
- What active listening behaviors made you feel respected?
- How can these communication practices support inclusion in diverse groups?

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8.3: Communication in Diverse Groups - Assignment

Reflecting on Communication in Diverse Groups

Purpose

This assignment provides an opportunity to analyze verbal and nonverbal communication, evaluate active listening skills, and apply inclusive communication practices in diverse group settings.

Upon completion of this assignment, learners will be able to:

1. Analyze the role of verbal and nonverbal communication in shaping understanding, relationships, and effectiveness within diverse group interactions.
2. Evaluate their active listening skills by reflecting on their ability to accurately interpret, summarize, and respond to others' perspectives.
3. Examine how differences in identities, experiences, and communication styles influence group dynamics and interpersonal communication.
4. Develop and justify inclusive communication strategies that promote respect, equity, and meaningful participation in collaborative environments.

Instructions

After completing the in-class activity (*Listen, Observe, Include*), write a reflection paper that addresses the following questions:

1. Verbal and Nonverbal Communication

- Describe at least two verbal and two nonverbal communication behaviors you observed during the activity.
- Explain how these behaviors affected understanding, engagement, or rapport between partners.

2. Active Listening

- Reflect on your experience as both a speaker and a listener.
- What active listening strategies were effective? What challenges, if any, did you encounter?

3. Communication Across Differences

- Discuss how differences in experiences, perspectives, identities, or communication styles can influence group interactions.
- Provide an example from the activity or another personal experience.

4. Inclusive Communication Practices

- Identify two strategies you can use to foster more respectful, equitable, and inclusive communication in future group settings.
- Explain how these strategies can improve collaboration and group effectiveness.

Submission Requirements

- Length: 400–500 words

- Format: Double-spaced, 12-point font, 1-inch margins
- Use MLA citations if referencing course materials

Communication in Diverse Groups - Classroom Activity

In-Class Activity: Communication in Diverse Groups

Listen, Observe, Include

Purpose:

This activity helps learners recognize verbal and nonverbal communication cues, practice active listening, and apply inclusive communication strategies in a group setting.

Upon completion of this activity, learners will be able to:

1. Recognize verbal and nonverbal communication cues that influence understanding and engagement during group interactions.
2. Demonstrate active listening skills by accurately summarizing another person's perspective without interruption or judgment.
3. Reflect on how individual experiences and identities shape communication styles and perceptions within diverse groups.
4. Apply inclusive communication practices that promote respect, empathy, and equitable participation in collaborative settings.

Instructions (5 minutes total):

Step 1: Pair Share (2 minutes)

- Students pair up.
- Partner A has 1 minute to answer the prompt:

"Describe a time when you felt included or excluded in a group."

- Partner B listens without interrupting and pays attention to both verbal and nonverbal cues.

Step 2: Reflection and Feedback (2 minutes)

- Partner B summarizes what they heard in 30 seconds, focusing on the speaker's key message and emotions.
- Partner A provides feedback on whether they felt heard and understood.
- Switch roles and repeat.

Step 3: Whole-Class Debrief (1 minute)

Ask students:

- What nonverbal cues helped you understand your partner?
- What active listening behaviors made you feel respected?
- How can these communication practices support inclusion in diverse groups?

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

9: Group Roles and Group Culture

[9.1: Group Roles and Group Culture – Readings and Videos](#)

[9.2: Group Roles and Group Culture - Classroom Activity](#)

[9.3: Group Roles and Group Culture - Assignment](#)

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9.1: Group Roles and Group Culture – Readings and Videos

Readings

Reading 1

This reading examines formal and informal group roles, including task, maintenance, and individual roles, and analyzes how these roles influence group effectiveness, communication, and decision-making. The authors provide practical strategies for understanding role dynamics and improving collaboration within diverse groups.

Adams, K., & Galanes, G. J. (2021). *Communicating in groups: Applications and skills* (12th ed.). McGraw Hill. <https://www.mheducation.com/highered...260240643.html>

Reading 2

This reading explores how group norms, expectations, cohesion, and belonging develop over time and affect member participation and group success. It also offers strategies for fostering inclusive group cultures that encourage trust, engagement, and meaningful connections among members.

Read Chapters 2 and 3 in Corey, M. S., Corey, G., & Corey, C. (2021). *Groups: Process and practice* (10th ed.). Cengage Learning. <https://www.cengage.com/c/groups-pro...y-corey-corey/>

Videos

Video 1

This video explains how individuals take on different roles within teams and how recognizing these roles can improve collaboration, communication, and group effectiveness. It supports understanding formal and informal roles and how member contributions influence group functioning.

MindTools. (2019, April 30). *Belbin's team roles: How understanding team roles can improve teamwork* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZpYt5oWj3qM>

Video 2

This video explores how group culture develops through shared behaviors, expectations, and interactions among members. It highlights the importance of trust, psychological safety, and inclusive practices in strengthening group cohesion and creating environments where members feel valued and connected.

TED. (2015, June 1). *How to start changing an unhealthy work culture* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hm4U6w8R5Yk>

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9.2: Group Roles and Group Culture - Classroom Activity

Group Roles and Group Culture - Classroom Activity

Activity Title: “Building an Effective Team Culture”

Time: 10 minutes

Purpose:

This activity helps learners identify group roles, examine group norms, and develop strategies for creating a cohesive and inclusive group culture.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this activity, learners will be able to:

1. Identify formal and informal roles that emerge within groups and explain their impact on group functioning.
2. Recognize how group norms and expectations influence participation and collaboration.
3. Analyze factors that contribute to group cohesion, trust, and belonging.
4. Recommend strategies for creating an inclusive and effective group culture.

Activity Instructions

Step 1: Group Scenario Analysis (3 minutes)

Divide students into small groups of 3–5 members. Provide the following scenario:

Scenario: “The Challenging Team Project”

A team of five students is assigned to a major class project. One student immediately takes the leadership role and makes most decisions. Another student completes tasks quietly but rarely shares ideas. A third student frequently challenges others’ suggestions, creating tension. Two members are unsure about expectations because the group has not discussed deadlines, communication methods, or decision-making processes.

The group is struggling with participation, communication, and teamwork.

Step 2: Identify Roles and Norms (4 minutes)

Groups discuss and record responses to the following questions:

Group Roles

- What formal roles might this group need to establish?
- What informal roles are already developing?
- How do these roles help or hinder group effectiveness?

Group Culture and Norms

- What group norms are missing or unclear?
- How might unclear expectations affect participation and belonging?
- What behaviors would create a more positive group culture?

Step 3: Share and Reflect (3 minutes)

Each group shares one key observation and one recommendation.

Class discussion prompts:

- Which group roles contributed positively to teamwork?
- How can groups prevent one person from dominating discussions?
- What actions help members feel valued and included?
- How do shared norms strengthen group cohesion?

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9.3: Group Roles and Group Culture - Assignment

Group Roles and Group Culture – Assignment

Case Analysis Assignment: Group Roles and Group Culture

Analyzing Group Roles, Norms, and Culture in a Diverse Team

Purpose

This assignment allows learners to apply concepts of group roles, group norms, cohesion, and belonging to analyze how group dynamics influence effectiveness and inclusion.

Upon completion of this assignment, learners will be able to:

1. Identify and analyze how formal and informal group roles influence member participation, communication patterns, and overall group effectiveness.
2. Evaluate how group norms, expectations, and communication practices shape collaboration, decision-making, and team performance.
3. Analyze the factors that influence group cohesion, trust, belonging, and inclusion within diverse group environments.
4. Develop evidence-based strategies to improve group culture, enhance equitable participation, and strengthen teamwork and collaboration.

Case Scenario: *The New Project Team*

A diverse team of six employees is assigned to develop a community outreach project. Although members have different skills and experiences, the team begins experiencing challenges. One member frequently takes control of discussions and makes decisions without consulting others. Another member rarely speaks because they feel their ideas are overlooked. Two members prefer following established procedures, while others want to experiment with new approaches. The team has not clearly established expectations for communication, decision-making, or conflict resolution. As a result, meetings become less productive, members feel disconnected, and participation becomes unequal.

The team leader notices the lack of collaboration and wants to create a more inclusive and effective group culture.

Assignment Instructions

Write a 400-500 -word case analysis addressing the following questions:

1. Identify Group Roles

- Identify the formal and informal roles present in the group.
- Explain how these roles influence communication, participation, and overall group functioning.

2. Analyze Group Norms and Expectations

- How do unclear or ineffective norms affect member participation and productivity?

3. Evaluate Group Cohesion and Belonging

- What factors are contributing to low cohesion within the team?

- How might differences in communication styles, experiences, or perspectives affect feelings of belonging?

Submission Requirements

- Length: 400-500 words
- MLA format
- Include at least two course sources (readings/videos)
- Include a reference page

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

10: Leadership and Shared Power in Groups

[10.1: Leadership and Shared Power in Groups - Readings and Videos](#)

[10.2: Leadership and Shared Power in Groups - Classroom Activity](#)

[10.3: Leadership and Shared Power in Groups - Assignment](#)

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10.1: Leadership and Shared Power in Groups - Readings and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos explore how leadership approaches have evolved from traditional individual-centered models toward transformational, collaborative, and shared leadership practices that emphasize empowerment, trust, and collective responsibility. Together, they highlight how inclusive leadership, equitable power-sharing, and active participation strengthen group effectiveness, promote belonging, and support positive social change in diverse groups.

Reading 1

This reading examines shared leadership as a process in which influence and responsibility are distributed among team members rather than concentrated in one formal leader. It explores how empowering leadership practices strengthen collaboration, participation, and team effectiveness.

Klasmeier, K. N., Güntner, A. V., & Schleu, J. E. (2025). Leadership dynamics in teams: The reciprocity of shared and empowering leadership. *Journal of Business and Psychology*, 40, 1171–1187. <https://link.springer.com/article/10...69-025-10008-9>

Reading 2

This reading explores how collaborative and transformational leadership approaches can support organizations working toward social change. It emphasizes shared values, empowerment, relationships, and collective responsibility as important elements of leadership that promote inclusion and community impact.

Osula, B., & Ng, E. C. W. (2014). Toward a collaborative, transformative model of nonprofit leadership: Some conceptual building blocks. *Administrative Sciences*, 4(2), 87–104. <https://www.mdpi.com/2076-3387/4/2/87>

Videos

Video 1

This video introduces transformational leadership theory and explains how leaders inspire, motivate, and develop others through vision, empowerment, and support. It connects leadership behaviors to team motivation, creativity, and positive change in group settings.

Clayton, M. (2023, November 20). *What is transformational leadership?* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s89ZXYWx5l4>

Video 2

This TEDx talk explores shared leadership as a model where responsibility, decision-making, and influence are distributed among group members rather than held by one individual. It highlights how shared power, trust, communication, and collaboration can strengthen team performance and inclusion.

Ramey, W. (2023). *Shared leadership: The collaborative edge for the future of work* [Video]. TEDxDrexelU. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LbR4KNZbKQs>

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10.2: Leadership and Shared Power in Groups - Classroom Activity

Leadership and Shared Power in Groups - Classroom Activity

“Who Has the Voice? Exploring Leadership and Power in Groups”

Time: 10 minutes

Purpose:

This activity helps learners examine different leadership approaches, explore how power is distributed within groups, and identify strategies for creating more inclusive and collaborative group environments.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this activity, learners will be able to:

1. Identify different leadership styles and their impact on group dynamics.
2. Analyze how power and decision-making influence participation in groups.
3. Evaluate the benefits of transformational and collaborative leadership approaches.
4. Develop strategies for promoting inclusive and equitable group leadership.

Activity Instructions

Step 1: Leadership Scenario Discussion (3 minutes)

Divide students into small groups (3–5 members) and provide the following scenario:

Scenario: “The Unequal Team Meeting”

A project team is preparing a major presentation. The team leader makes most decisions, assigns tasks without discussion, and rarely asks for input from quieter members. Two team members have valuable ideas but do not share them because they feel their perspectives are not being considered. Other members complete assigned tasks but feel disconnected from the overall project goals.

Discussion Questions:

- What leadership style is being demonstrated?
- How does the current leadership approach affect group participation?
- Who has power in this situation, and who does not?

Step 2: Redesign the Leadership Approach (4 minutes)

Groups redesign the scenario using a shared-power leadership model.

Discuss:

- How could the leader involve more voices in decision-making?
- What responsibilities could be shared among group members?
- What practices would help create a more inclusive environment?

Groups identify three changes they would make, such as:

- Rotating leadership responsibilities
- Creating opportunities for all members to contribute

- Establishing shared group goals and expectations
- Encouraging feedback and open communication

Step 3: Class Reflection and Debrief (3 minutes)

Groups share one leadership challenge and one recommended solution.

Instructor discussion prompts:

- How is collaborative leadership different from traditional leadership?
- When might shared leadership improve group effectiveness?
- How can leaders ensure that power is distributed equitably?

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10.3: Leadership and Shared Power in Groups - Assignment

Leadership and Shared Power in Groups: 6 Slides with Voice-Over Narration/Speaker Notes

Assignment Purpose

This assignment allows learners to demonstrate their understanding of leadership theories, shared power, transformational and collaborative leadership approaches, and equity-centered leadership practices in diverse groups.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this assignment, learners will be able to:

1. Analyze traditional, transformational, and collaborative leadership theories and their impact on group dynamics.
2. Evaluate how shared power and collective decision-making influence group effectiveness and participation.
3. Examine how leadership practices can promote equity, inclusion, and social justice within diverse groups.
4. Develop leadership strategies that strengthen collaboration, belonging, and positive group change.

Assignment Instructions

Create a 6-slide presentation with voice-over narration or detailed speaker notes. Your presentation should analyze a leadership situation in a group, organization, classroom, workplace, or community setting.

Presentation Length: 5–7 minutes

Format: PowerPoint, Google Slides, or similar presentation platform

Sources: Include at least two course readings/videos using APA 7th edition citations.

Slide 1: Title Slide – Leadership and Shared Power in Groups

Slide Content:

- Presentation title
- Your name
- Course name
- Date

Speaker Notes/Narration:

Introduce your topic and explain why effective leadership and shared power are important in diverse groups. Briefly describe the leadership situation or example you will analyze.

Slide 2: Leadership Situation and Context

Slide Content:

- Describe the group, organization, or situation
- Identify the leadership challenge or opportunity
- Explain why leadership matters in this context

Speaker Notes/Narration:

Provide background information about the group and explain the leadership issue. Discuss how leadership decisions affect communication, participation, and group outcomes.

Slide 3: Analysis of Leadership Theory

Slide Content:

- Identify the leadership approach currently being used:

Traditional leadership

Transformational leadership

Collaborative/shared leadership

- Strengths and limitations of the approach

Speaker Notes/Narration:

Explain the leadership theory and connect it to course concepts. Analyze how the leadership approach influences group dynamics, motivation, decision-making, and member engagement.

Slide 4: Shared Power and Collaboration**Slide Content:**

- How power is distributed within the group
- Examples of shared decision-making
- Strategies for increasing participation

Speaker Notes/Narration:

Discuss how shared leadership can create opportunities for group members to contribute their knowledge, experiences, and perspectives. Explain how collaborative leadership can improve trust, creativity, and effectiveness.

Slide 5: Equity, Inclusion, and Social Justice in Leadership**Slide Content:**

- Identify equity or inclusion challenges
- Explain how leadership can address barriers
- Provide strategies for inclusive change

Speaker Notes/Narration:

Analyze how leadership practices can promote fairness, belonging, and meaningful participation. Discuss the importance of recognizing different identities, experiences, and perspectives when making group decisions.

Slide 6: Recommendations and Reflection**Slide Content:**

- Three recommendations for improving leadership effectiveness
- Key lessons learned
- References (MLA)

Speaker Notes/Narration:

Summarize your analysis and explain how leaders can create more inclusive, collaborative, and effective groups. Reflect on how shared power can strengthen relationships and support positive change.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

11: Conflict, Dialogue, and Restorative Practices in Groups

[11.1: Conflict, Dialogue, and Restorative Practices in Groups – Readings and Videos Readings](#)

[11.2: Conflict, Dialogue, and Restorative Practices in Groups - Classroom Activity](#)

[11.3: Conflict, Dialogue, and Restorative Practices in Groups - Assignment](#)

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11.1: Conflict, Dialogue, and Restorative Practices in Groups – Readings and Videos Readings

Readings

The readings and videos examine conflict as a relational and social process that can be transformed through dialogue, empathy, accountability, and restoration. Together, these resources help learners understand the causes of group conflict, apply conflict transformation frameworks, and use restorative justice approaches to repair harm and strengthen relationships. These video resources reinforce the importance of moving from adversarial responses to collaborative approaches that build trust and support positive group interactions.

Reading 1

This reading examines how restorative justice connects with conflict transformation and peacebuilding. It supports learners in understanding how restorative approaches address harm, accountability, relationships, and healing processes within groups and communities.

Howard Zehr (2009). The intersection of restorative justice with trauma healing, conflict transformation and peacebuilding. *Journal for Peace and Justice Studies*, 18(1/2), 20–30. https://www.pdcnet.org/pdc/bvdb.nsf/...0001_0020_0030

Reading 2

This reading explores the psychological and relational dimensions of conflict transformation, including empathy, narratives, identity, and social processes that help groups move from destructive conflict toward constructive engagement.

Laura K. Taylor, & John Paul Lederach (2014). Practicing peace: Psychological roots of transforming conflicts. *Global Journal of Peace Research and Praxis*, 1(1), 12–31. <https://pure.qub.ac.uk/en/publication...ing-conflicts/>

Videos

Video 1

This video explores how restorative practices can transform responses to conflict by emphasizing accountability, empathy, dialogue, and repairing relationships. It is useful for examining restorative approaches in schools, communities, and group settings.

Hutchison, K. (2013, June 10). *Restorative practices to resolve conflict/build relationships* [Video]. TEDxWestVancouverED. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wcLuVeHlrSs>

Video 2

This video supports understanding of restorative dialogue processes, including facilitated communication, listening, mediation, and relationship repair following conflict. It connects directly to conflict transformation and restorative justice approaches in groups.

Umbreit, M. S. (n.d.). *Peacebuilding through restorative justice dialogue* [Video]. Center for Restorative Justice and Peacemaking, University of Minnesota Duluth. <https://rjp.d.umn.edu/resources/learning->

videos?

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11.2: Conflict, Dialogue, and Restorative Practices in Groups - Classroom Activity

“From Conflict to Restoration”

Purpose:

To help learners identify sources of group conflict and practice conflict transformation and restorative dialogue strategies.

Time: 5 minutes

Activity Steps:

1. Present a Scenario (1 minute)

Share the following example:

“A group project team has conflict because two members feel they are doing most of the work, while another member feels their ideas are being ignored.”

2. Small-Group Reflection (2 minutes)

Ask students to discuss:

What are the possible sources of conflict in this situation?

How might each person’s perspective or needs contribute to the conflict?

What questions could be asked to begin a restorative dialogue?

3. Restorative Response Sharing (2 minutes)

Invite students to share one response using restorative practice principles:

What happened?

Who was affected?

What needs to happen to repair the situation?

How can the group move forward together?

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11.3: Conflict, Dialogue, and Restorative Practices in Groups - Assignment

Assignment: Case Study Analysis – “Repairing Trust in a Divided Team”

Student Learning Objectives

By the end of this assignment, students will be able to:

- Identify and analyze sources of conflict in groups, including communication issues, differing perspectives, and unmet needs.
- Apply conflict transformation principles to develop constructive responses to interpersonal and group conflict.
- Demonstrate understanding of dialogue practices that encourage listening, empathy, and collaboration.
- Apply restorative justice approaches to repair harm, promote accountability, and strengthen relationships within groups.

Purpose

This assignment allows students to apply concepts of conflict sources, conflict transformation, dialogue, and restorative practices to analyze a real-world group conflict scenario and develop a restorative response.

Case Study: *The Community Health Project Team Conflict*

A five-member community health project team was formed to design a local wellness program. At the beginning of the project, team members were enthusiastic and shared ideas openly. However, after several weeks, tensions began to develop.

Two members felt frustrated because they believed they were completing most of the research and writing tasks, while other members were not contributing equally. Another team member felt excluded because their suggestions were frequently dismissed during meetings. A disagreement about the project direction led to personal criticism, reduced communication, and some members avoiding meetings.

The team leader attempted to solve the issue by assigning additional tasks and setting deadlines, but the conflict continued. Some members argued that the problem was a lack of commitment, while others believed the real issue was poor communication, unclear expectations, and a lack of trust. The team must now decide how to address the conflict and rebuild effective collaboration before the project deadline.

Assignment Tasks

Part 1: Identify Sources of Conflict (25 points)

Analyze the case study and identify:

- The main sources of conflict within the group.
- The underlying needs, values, or concerns of each stakeholder.
- How communication patterns contributed to the conflict.

Part 2: Conflict Transformation Analysis (25 points)

Using conflict transformation concepts:

- Explain how the conflict could be viewed as an opportunity for learning and improvement.
- Identify strategies that could transform the relationships and group dynamics.
- Describe how the team could move from blame and disagreement toward collaboration.

Part 3: Develop a Restorative Dialogue Plan (30 points)

Create a restorative meeting plan that includes:

- Key questions that should be asked during the dialogue (For example, “What happened?” “Who was affected?” “What needs to happen to repair the situation?”).
- Roles of participants (facilitator, team members, affected individuals).
- Steps for rebuilding trust and accountability.

Part 4: Personal Reflection (20 points)

Write a short reflection (300–500 words) addressing:

- What did you learn about managing conflict in groups?
- How can dialogue and restorative practices improve group relationships?
- How might you apply these approaches in future teamwork situations?

Submission Guidelines

- Length: 1,000–1,500 words
- Format: MLA (where sources are used)
- Include at least two course readings or resources to support your analysis.
- Submit as an individual assignment or group presentation (as determined by the instructor).

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

12: Bias, Stereotypes, and Decision-Making in Groups

[12.1: Bias, Stereotypes, and Decision-Making in Groups – Readings and Videos Readings](#)

[12.2: Bias, Stereotypes, and Decision-Making in Groups - Classroom Activity](#)

[12.3: Bias, Stereotypes, and Decision-Making in Groups - Assignment](#)

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12.1: Bias, Stereotypes, and Decision-Making in Groups – Readings and Videos Readings

Readings

The readings and videos help learners understand how implicit biases and stereotypes influence perceptions of others and shape interactions within groups. They also demonstrate how conformity pressures and groupthink can undermine critical thinking and ethical decision-making, while highlighting strategies to encourage diverse perspectives and better group outcomes.

Reading 1

This reading examines how implicit social biases shape perceptions of individuals from out-groups, providing insight into the ways stereotypes and unconscious assumptions can affect group interactions and decision-making.

Chen, W., Kassa, M. T., & Cheung, O. S. (2023). *The role of implicit social bias on holistic processing of out-group faces*. *Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications*, 8(1), Article 7. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41235-023-00464-3>

Reading 2

This article explores how groupthink develops through closed-mindedness and insulation from alternative viewpoints and demonstrates how structured dissent (devil's advocacy) can improve ethical and effective group decision-making.

Akhmad, M., Chang, S., & Deguchi, H. (2021). *Closed-mindedness and insulation in groupthink: Their effects and the devil's advocacy as a preventive measure*. *Journal of Computational Social Science*, 4(1), 455–478. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s42001-020-00083-8>

Videos

Video 1

This TEDx talk explores how hidden biases and cognitive blind spots influence decision-making and judgment. It helps learners understand the role of implicit bias in individual and group decisions and offers strategies for improving critical thinking.

Carter, S. (2018, November). *Decision making deconstructed: Understanding the role of bias* [Video]. TEDxCalgary. TED. https://www.ted.com/talks/stephen_ca...e_role_of_bias

Video 2

This instructional video explains conformity, group polarization, and groupthink, highlighting how pressure for consensus can affect ethical decision-making and suppress diverse viewpoints in groups.

Walsh, J. (2014). *Conformity and groupthink* [Video]. Khan Academy. <https://www.khanacademy.org/test-pre...and-groupthink>

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12.2: Bias, Stereotypes, and Decision-Making in Groups - Classroom Activity

“Spot the Bias, Improve the Decision”

Purpose

To help students identify implicit bias, stereotypes, groupthink, and ethical decision-making challenges in group situations.

Time

5 minutes

Activity: Case Analysis

Scenario (1 minute):

A student group is choosing a leader for a class project. Most members quickly select the most outspoken person because they believe this person will be the best leader. A quieter member has strong organizational skills and experience but is not considered. When one person questions the choice, the group agrees to move forward to avoid disagreement and save time.

Step 1: Identify the Issue (2 minutes)

Students discuss with a partner or small group:

- What types of bias or stereotypes might be influencing the group’s decision?
- How might conformity or groupthink be affecting the discussion?
- Who might be excluded or overlooked in this decision?

Step 2: Create a Better Approach (2 minutes)

Students suggest strategies the group could use to make a more ethical and inclusive decision:

- How could the group encourage different perspectives?
- What questions should members ask before making a decision?
- How could the group ensure all members have an opportunity to contribute?

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12.3: Bias, Stereotypes, and Decision-Making in Groups - Assignment

3-Minute Video Assignment: Recognizing Bias and Improving Group Decisions

Purpose

This assignment helps students reflect on how implicit bias, stereotypes, groupthink, and ethical decision-making influence group interactions.

Instructions

After reviewing the assigned readings and videos, create a 3-minute video presentation addressing the following questions:

Video Content Guidelines

1. Explain the Concept (1 minute)

- Define one key concept:

Implicit bias

Stereotypes

Groupthink and conformity

Ethical decision-making in groups

- Explain why this concept matters in group interactions.

2. Provide an Example (1 minute)

- Share a real-life or hypothetical example of how bias, stereotypes, or group pressure can affect a group's decisions.
- Describe how the situation could negatively impact communication, inclusion, or outcomes.

3. Suggest a Solution (1 minute)

- Identify one or two strategies groups can use to:

Reduce bias and stereotypes

Encourage diverse perspectives

Avoid groupthink

Make more ethical decisions

Submission Requirements

- Video length: 3 minutes maximum
- Students may record using a phone, computer, or course video platform.
- Use clear communication and include examples.
- Cite any course readings or videos referenced using MLA format.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

13: Trauma-Informed and Healing-Centered Group Practices

[13.1: Trauma-Informed and Healing-Centered Group Practices – Readings and Videos](#)

[13.2: Trauma-Informed and Healing-Centered Group Practices - Classroom Activity](#)

[13.3: Trauma-Informed and Healing-Centered Group Practices - Assignment](#)

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13.1: Trauma-Informed and Healing-Centered Group Practices – Readings and Videos

The readings and videos collectively explore how trauma affects learning, behavior, relationships, and organizational experiences while emphasizing the importance of trauma-aware practices, psychological safety, and healing-centered engagement. Together, they highlight the value of creating supportive, inclusive, and strengths-based environments that foster trust, belonging, resilience, agency, and healing across educational and organizational settings.

Readings

Reading 1

This reading examines trauma-informed classroom practices, including how educators can recognize trauma impacts, build supportive learning environments, and address barriers to student engagement and well-being. It supports outcomes focused on identifying trauma effects and applying trauma-aware practices.

Zelege, N. A., & colleagues. (2022). *What is a trauma-informed classroom? What are the benefits and challenges involved?* *Frontiers in Education*, 7, Article 914448. <https://doi.org/10.3389/feduc.2022.914448>

Reading 2

This reading presents a framework that integrates trauma-informed care, restorative practices, and multicultural education. It emphasizes relationships, safety, belonging, and agency as foundations for healing-centered educational environments and psychological safety.

Parameswaran, U. D., Molloy, J., & Kuttner, P. (2024). *Healing schools: A framework for joining trauma-informed care, restorative justice, and multicultural education for whole school reform*. *The Urban Review*, 56, 186–209. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11256-023-00666-5>

Videos

Video 1

This video explains how trauma-informed approaches help schools recognize the effects of trauma and build supportive, safe, and responsive learning environments.

Science Animated. (2020, February 13). *Trauma-informed schools and practices* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TxL5Jw0TcDY>

Video 2

This video introduces foundational trauma-informed care concepts, including understanding trauma responses, building trust, and supporting individuals through safe and responsive interactions.

University of California, San Francisco, Child and Adolescent Psychiatry Portal. (n.d.). *Trauma-informed care 101* [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RgfXSn1_AzE

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13.2: Trauma-Informed and Healing-Centered Group Practices - Classroom Activity

“Safety to Belong: A Quick Design Challenge”

Purpose:

Help students apply trauma awareness, psychological safety, and healing-centered engagement concepts to real-world settings.

Time: 5 minutes

Activity Steps**1. Scenario Reflection (1 minute)**

Present this scenario:

"A student or employee regularly withdraws from group discussions, misses deadlines, or appears disengaged. Others interpret the behavior as a lack of motivation or commitment."

Ask students:

“What are three possible reasons behind this behavior if we view it through a trauma-aware lens?”

2. Reframe the Response (2 minutes)

In pairs or small groups, students answer:

- What assumptions might people make about this person?
- How could a psychologically safe environment respond differently?
- What is one healing-centered strategy that could support this person?

3. Share & Connect (2 minutes)

Invite groups to share one idea. Capture responses under three headings:

Trauma Awareness → *Understand the behavior*

Psychological Safety → *Create trust and belonging*

Healing-Centered Engagement → *Support strengths and agency*

Closing Reflection Question:

"How might our response change when we move from asking 'What is wrong with this person?' to 'What support or conditions might help this person thrive?'"

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13.3: Trauma-Informed and Healing-Centered Group Practices - Assignment

“Designing for Healing: A Trauma-Aware Practice Reflection”

Length: 2–3 pages (excluding title page)

Purpose: To apply concepts of trauma awareness, psychological safety, and healing-centered engagement to a real or imagined educational or organizational setting.

Assignment Overview

Students will create a Trauma-Aware Improvement Proposal that reimagines an environment (classroom, workplace, community organization, team, or program) to better support safety, belonging, and healing. Rather than conducting research, students will use course concepts and personal/professional observations to identify opportunities for more compassionate and responsive practices.

Assignment Prompt

Imagine you have been invited to redesign an environment where people learn, work, or collaborate. Using the principles of trauma awareness, psychological safety, and healing-centered engagement, develop a brief proposal that answers:

1. **What is the challenge?**

Describe a common situation or practice that may create stress, disconnection, exclusion, or barriers to participation.

2. **What needs to change?**

Explain how trauma-aware thinking changes the way we understand people’s behaviors, needs, and experiences.

3. **What would a healing-centered environment look like?**

Propose 3–5 specific strategies, practices, or cultural shifts that promote:

Trust and emotional safety

Belonging and inclusion

Voice, choice, and agency

Strengths and resilience

4. **Your Leadership Reflection**

Describe your role in creating psychologically safe spaces. What attitudes, behaviors, or practices would you personally commit to developing?

Creative Element (Choose One)

Include one innovative component that represents your vision for a healing-centered environment:

- A “Psychological Safety Blueprint” (visual map of your proposed environment)
- A “Trauma-Aware Manifesto” (a set of guiding principles or commitments)
- A “Before and After” scenario showing how a situation changes through trauma-responsive practice
- A Letter to Future Leaders describing how they can create environments where people thrive

Requirements

- 2–3 pages, double-spaced
- Use course readings/videos as conceptual references (no outside research required)
- **Demonstrate understanding of:**

Trauma awareness

Psychological safety

Healing-centered engagement

Application to practice

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

14: Community Organizing and Collective Action

[14.1: Community Organizing and Collective Action – Reading and Videos](#)

[14.2: Community Organizing and Collective Action - Classroom Activity](#)

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14.1: Community Organizing and Collective Action – Reading and Videos

Readings

The readings and videos for this module demonstrate how grassroots organizing, coalition building, and community participation empower individuals and groups to address social issues and create meaningful change. They emphasize the importance of leadership, collaboration, relationship-building, and collective action in developing and sustaining successful social movements.

Reading 1

This reading supports student understanding of coalition building by examining how community history, relationships, shared values, and local conditions influence the development of effective coalitions. Students can explore how organizations collaborate to address complex social issues.

Kegler, M. C., Rigler, J., & Honeycutt, S. (2010).

How does community context influence coalitions in the formation stage? A multiple case study based on the Community Coalition Action Theory. *BMC Public Health*, 10, Article 90. <https://bmcpublichealth.biomedcentral.com/articles/10.1186/1471-2458-10-90>

Reading 2

This reading connects community empowerment, social movements, and collective action by examining how communities organize around shared concerns and sustain long-term change through participation and collaboration.

Tremblay, M. C., Martin, D. H., McComber, A. M., McGregor, A., & Macaulay, A. C. (2018). Understanding community-based participatory research through a social movement framework: A case study of the Kahnawake Schools Diabetes Prevention Project. *BMC Public Health*, 18, Article 487. <https://bmcpublichealth.biomedcentra...889-018-5412-y>

Video

Video 1

This video supports the concept of grassroots organizing by exploring how community relationships, leadership development, and collective participation create long-term social change.

Lee, N'Tanya. (2019).

Grassroots Organizing Builds Power [Video]. Barnard Center for Research on Women. <https://bcrw.barnard.edu/videos/ntan...-builds-power/>

Video 2

This video introduces concepts related to group mobilization, leadership, participation, and movement development. It helps students examine how individuals become engaged in collective action and how movements grow.

TED-Ed. (2017). *How to Start a Movement* [Video]. TED-Ed. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V74AxCqOTvg>

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14.2: Community Organizing and Collective Action - Classroom Activity

10-Minute Classroom Activity: Community Action Challenge

Purpose

Students will apply concepts of grassroots organizing, coalition building, social movements, and group mobilization to address a community issue.

Instructions (10 minutes total):

Step 1: Form Small Groups (2 minutes)

Divide students into groups of 3–4. Assign or allow each group to select a community issue (e.g., food insecurity, homelessness, neighborhood safety, mental health awareness, environmental concerns).

Step 2: Develop an Action Plan (5 minutes)

Each group answers the following questions:

1. How would you use grassroots organizing to engage community members?
2. What organizations or stakeholders would you include in a coalition?
3. How would you mobilize people to support the cause?
4. What would be one goal of your social movement or collective action effort?

Step 3: Share Out (3 minutes)

Each group provides a 30-second summary of its action plan. Encourage students to identify similarities and differences in their approaches.

Debrief Question:

Which strategy—grassroots organizing, coalition building, or group mobilization—do you think is most critical for creating lasting community change, and why?

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14.3: Community Organizing and Collective Action - Assignment

Assignment: Community Organizing and Collective Action Plan

Purpose:

This assignment provides students with an opportunity to apply concepts of grassroots organizing, coalition building, social movements, and group mobilization to a real-world community issue.

Instructions:

Select a current community issue that is important to you (e.g., food insecurity, homelessness, mental health awareness, environmental sustainability, access to healthcare, youth violence prevention, or educational equity). Develop a 2–3 page Community Action Plan that outlines how community members and organizations could work together to address the issue.

Your action plan should include the following components:

1. Community Issue Description

- Describe the issue and its impact on the community.
- Explain why it is important to address.

2. Grassroots Organizing Strategy

- Identify ways to engage community members.
- Explain how you would build awareness and encourage participation.

3. Coalition Building Plan

- Identify at least three stakeholders, organizations, or groups that could support the effort.
- Explain the role each would play in the coalition.

4. Mobilization and Social Movement Strategy

- Describe how you would encourage collective action.
- Discuss activities, events, campaigns, or advocacy efforts that could advance the cause.

5. Expected Outcomes

- Identify two short-term goals and one long-term goal for your initiative.
- Explain how success would be measured.

6. Reflection

- Discuss the challenges that may arise when organizing community members and building coalitions.
- Explain what leadership skills would be most important for success.

Requirements:

- 2–3 pages, double-spaced
 - APA 7th edition format
 - Include at least two scholarly sources from the module readings or other peer-reviewed sources
 - Include a title page and reference page
-

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

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15.1: Groups in Organizations and Institutions – Readings and Videos

Reading 1

This reading examines how shared norms and psychological safety influence communication, learning, collaboration, and performance within organizations.

Edmondson, A. (2019). The role of psychological safety: Maximizing employee input and commitment. *Leader to Leader*, 2019(92), 13–19. <https://doi.org/10.1002/ltl.20419>

Reading 2

This reading discusses institutional change and organizational development. Kotter identifies common barriers to successful organizational transformation and presents leadership practices that support sustainable change.

Kotter, J. P. (1995). Leading change: Why transformation efforts fail. *Harvard Business Review*, 73(2), 59–67. <https://hbr.org/1995/03/leading-change-why-transformation-efforts-fail-2>

Videos

Video 1

This video discusses equity and inclusion initiatives, workplace relationships, employee experiences, and organizational performance. The presentation challenges common assumptions about diversity, equity, and inclusion and discusses strategies for creating inclusive organizational cultures.

Lindor, C. (2022, May 20). *Diversity, equity, and inclusion isn't what you think* [Video]. TEDx Talks. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H2CFG_ABORM

Video 2

This video discusses equity, inclusion, organizational culture, and group behavior. Stovall presents actionable approaches for creating workplaces where employees can contribute authentically and effectively.

Stovall, J. (2018, September 13). *How to get serious about diversity and inclusion in the workplace* [Video]. TED. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kvdHqS3ryw0>

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15.2: Groups in Organizations and Institutions - Classroom Activity

Activity: "Culture, Inclusion, and Change Snapshot"

Time: 10 minutes

Format: Zoom/Teams breakout rooms (3–4 students per group)

Scenario (1 minute)

Display this scenario:

A mid-sized company has shifted to a hybrid work model. Leadership wants to improve collaboration and innovation, but employee surveys reveal that remote employees feel excluded from important decisions. Long-time employees resist new communication tools, and employee engagement has declined. Management has launched an equity and inclusion initiative and is asking teams for recommendations.

Small Group Discussion (6 minutes)

Each breakout group answers three questions, assigning one person to report out.

Question 1 – Organizational Culture (2 minutes)

- What aspects of the company's culture are helping or hurting teamwork?
- Identify at least one shared value, norm, or behavior influencing employee engagement.

Learning Outcome: Analyze organizational culture and its influence on group dynamics and organizational effectiveness.

Question 2 – Equity and Inclusion (2 minutes)

- How might the current situation affect different groups of employees?
- Suggest one equity or inclusion initiative that could improve workplace relationships.

Learning Outcome: Examine equity and inclusion initiatives and their impact.

Question 3 – Organizational Change (2 minutes)

- What is one reason employees may resist the changes?
- Recommend one strategy leaders should use to successfully implement the change.

Learning Outcome: Evaluate institutional change processes and implementation strategies.

Whole-Class Debrief (3 minutes)

Invite each group to share one recommendation (30–45 seconds each).

As students report, organize responses into three columns:

Culture	Equity & Inclusion	Change Strategy
Shared norms	Inclusive communication	Employee involvement
Trust	Psychological safety	Transparent communication
Collaboration	Equal access	Training & support

Culture	Equity & Inclusion	Change Strategy
Accountability	Belonging	Leadership modeling

Finish with a reflection question:

Which of these three areas—culture, inclusion, or change—do you think has the greatest influence on organizational success, and why?

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15.3: Groups in Organizations and Institutions - Assignment

Culture, Inclusion, and Change Analysis

Length: 1–2 pages (or 300–500 words)

Instructions

Choose a workplace you know (current job, previous job, volunteer organization, or a company you have researched). Respond to the following questions:

1. Analyze one aspect of the organization's culture (shared values, norms, or behaviors) and explain how it affects group dynamics or employee engagement.
2. Evaluate one equity and inclusion initiative (existing or proposed) and discuss its potential impact on employees and workplace relationships.
3. Recommend one strategy the organization could use to successfully implement a change that would improve organizational effectiveness. Explain why your recommendation would be effective.

Submission Requirements

- 300–500 words (or 1–2 pages)
- Support your ideas with at least one course concept or one scholarly source
- Include specific examples to support your responses.

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